



Assessment of Mental Health Patients in Emergency Department (Acute) Protocol

ALERT • If at any time, the situation deteriorates; call security or Code Black as appropriate, by using installed Code Black alert devices in hold room and near patient bunks as well as under all counters in the Emergency Department (ED).

Preamble

Consumer Participation

The Rockingham Peel Group (RKPG) recognises and fully supports the need for the patient and/or their primary carer to¹:

- Know and exercise their healthcare rights.
- Be engaged in their healthcare.
- Have access to information about treatment options.
- Participate in treatment decisions.
- Have access to information about agreed treatment plans.

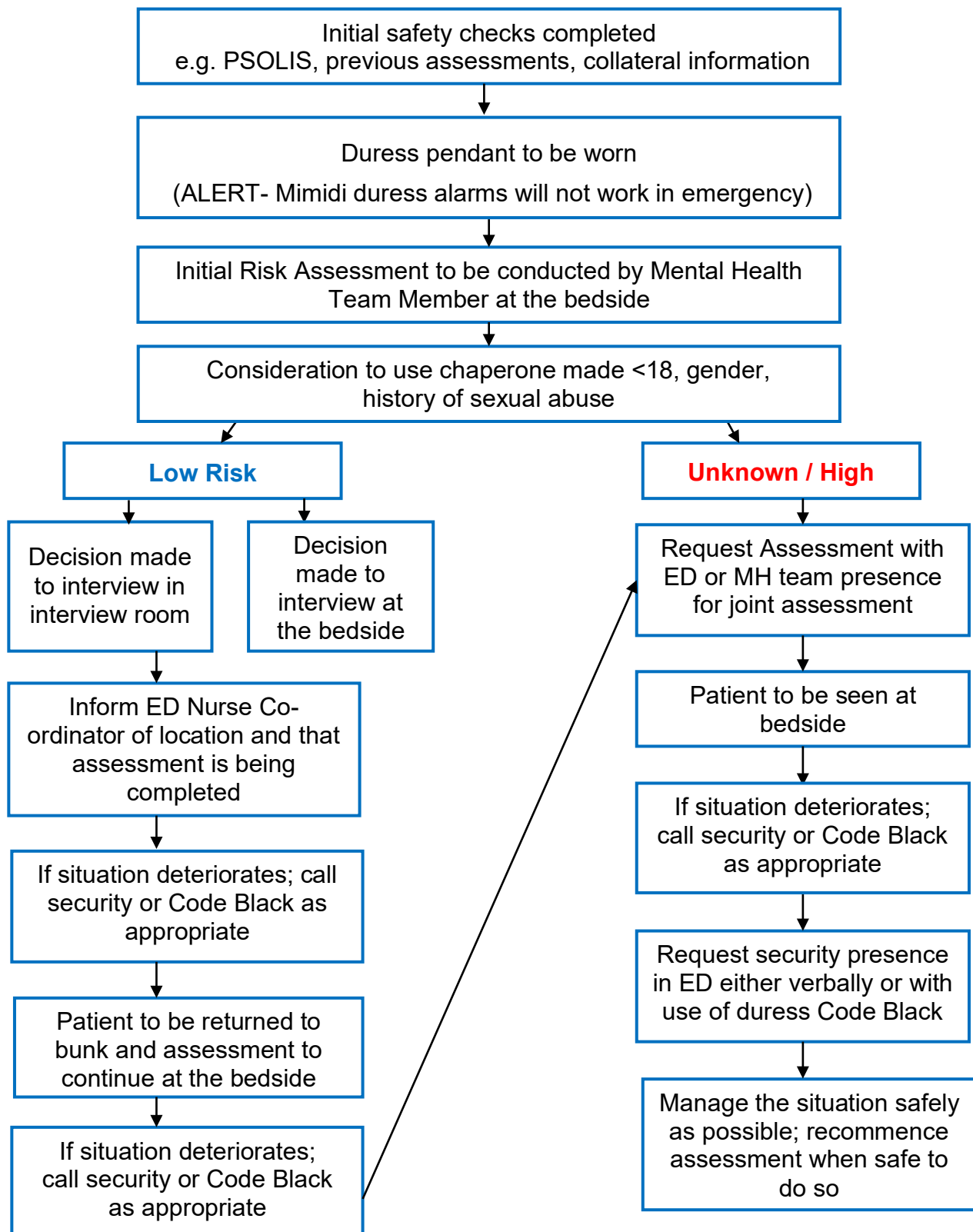
Scope of Practice

It is the responsibility of each health care provider to ensure all patient care and therapeutic interventions they provide are within their individual scope of practice. Refer to the [RKPG Guidelines to Writing for Clinical Policy](#) for further information about Scope of Practice.

- The ED Mental Health Team provides a skilled assessment and consultation service for patients referred to the mental health team in the emergency department.
- A check to be made on the Psychiatric Services Online Information System (PSOLIS) and Emergency Department Information System (EDIS) for any alerts about the person to be assessed, prior to seeing the patient.
- Additionally staff may request that security check for alerts on their SENTRY database
- An initial risk assessment of each patient is required to determine a safe location for a comprehensive assessment to take place.
- It is the responsibility of the ED Mental Health Liaison Nurse (MHLN) to inform the ED coordinator who will update EDIS clinical comments to indicate time and location of where the assessment is to take place.
- The attached flowchart outlines the procedure to ensure patient and staff safety during the assessment process.

RESPONSIBILITY				NATIONAL STANDARDS
First Issued	Apr 2008	Revisions	May 2017, May 2020	National Standards 1, 5, 6 National Standards for Mental Health 2.9, 2.10, 2.11, 10.4.2
This version	Jul 2023	Revision Due	Jul 2026	
Responsibility of	Co-Directors Mental Health	Endorsed by	DONM/DCS	
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FLOWCHART



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Compliance monitoring

Compliance will be monitored by any clinical incidents via Datix

References

1. Australian Commission on Safety and Quality in Health Care (ACSQH). The National Safety and Quality Health Service Standards Safety and Quality Improvement Guide: Standard 1 Governance for Safety and Quality in Health Service Organisations. 2nd ed. (Version 2) 2021. Available from <https://www.safetyandquality.gov.au/our-work/assessment-to-the-nsqhs-standards/>

Links

[SMHS Workplace Aggression and Violence Policy](#)
[SMHS Workplace Aggression and Violence Procedure](#)

National Standards



National Standards for Mental Health Services

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